

Josh Rehders

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in your position. It's been my goal for as long as I can remember to bring my community together. At Vanderbilt, that was through mentorship in my organizations—and even more so through my photography. I use my photos to showcase the passion of my peers. To me, a photo captures a split-second moment, and to capture that moment is to capture the passion behind it. I believe passion humanizes us; it's one of the few things we all share. When combined with something as unifying as sports, it becomes a powerful force for community building.

My past experiences in photography help to demonstrate my desire to constantly grow within my craft, both individually and with the help of more experienced people around me.

Over the past four years, I've worked across sports media, starting with rebuilding sports coverage at The Vanderbilt Hustler, where I eventually served as Photography Director. Before that, I spent two years as Deputy Photography Director, overseeing credentialing for our sports and live event coverage while producing a large portion of our photo content. I also spent time as a student photographer with the Vanderbilt Athletic Department, creating live game-day content for usage across all social media platforms. That experience of collaborating with a full-time media team shaped my growth and confirmed how much I thrive in creative, collaborative spaces.

My freelance sports work has continually pushed me outside my comfort zone, offering new challenges and incredible opportunities. In summer 2024, I was hired by the University of Oregon Athletic Department to cover their NCAA College World Series run, beginning (and unfortunately ending) in College Station. In 2023, I traveled to Los Angeles on assignment for a news outlet to cover the College Football Playoff Championship. And earlier in my career, working with University of Washington Gymnastics in 2022, shooting an NCAA College World Series Regional in Dallas in 2021, as well as working with a Houston media outlet to cover Astros home games and the Texas 6A Baseball Playoffs each played monumental roles in my growth as a creative. Each assignment, big and small, gave me invaluable learning opportunities creatively and professionally while working alongside seasoned media professionals.

Outside of sports, I am a Photography Supplier for Vanderbilt's 500+ student organizations, continuing my mission to spotlight the passion of my peers. My work has included individual and group portraits, event coverage on and off campus, and even documenting a campus protest during the 2020 presidential debate. Around Nashville, I've covered concerts in venues ranging from intimate 100-seat rooms to 20,000-seat arenas. Most recently, I provided visual and written breaking news coverage of the Israel-Gaza-related protests at Vanderbilt, among the first on any U.S. campus. My reporting was cited by national outlets, and my photography was featured by TIME Magazine and awarded by multiple organizations. These experiences have not only sharpened my creative work but also deepened my understanding of the communities I document.

Since picking up a camera, I've grown tremendously. I started with a 15-year-old camera and have since upgrade plenty, but the heart of the craft remains unchanged. I'll never be done learning. This position aligns perfectly with what I value in my creative work: bringing the music community—fans, artists, and staff—closer together. Thank you for considering my application, and I look forward to discussing any next steps!

Sincerely,



Josh Rehders